PHILIPS 1000 SERIES 7.1L AIRFRYER

Does it add enough to your kitchen?

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Since we already have a microwave oven at home, my family was not sure whether we really needed an air fryer. We kept hearing from friends and seeing people online talk about air frying as a way to cook with less oil and make everyday food healthier. But there was also a simple question: what would an air fryer actually add to a kitchen, especially one that already has a microwave? Well, I can tell you my experience. I have been using the Philips 1000 series 7.1L Digital Airfryer (model NA154/00) for about a month. During that time, we used it for a variety of foods and cooking tasks, from snacks and vegetables to reheating and larger portions. It has been interesting to see where it genuinely makes cooking easier, where it falls short, and how often we actually reached for it. Here's our full review.

The double drawer idea

The Philips 1000 series air fryer has a rectangular cuboid shape with a sober yet neat-looking black colour. The touch-based control panel is present on the top, with two golden-accent handles on the front. There are sufficient controls, and the touch response is fine. The separate controls for the left and right sides are also intuitive, as they let you assign each side its own temperature and cooking time rather than compromising with one setting for everything.

Now, while buying it, note that at 367 mm, the Philips Airfryer does take up a fair amount of counter space. It weighs 3.26 kg. Philips lists a 0.8-metre power cord and a 2450W power rating. So placement needs some thought in the kitchen. You can't just place it anywhere or plug it into an extension board.

Moving to the internals, the Philips Airfryer has a double drawer. When you hear the 'double drawer' branding, don't think it is simply two completely separate baskets sitting next to each other. Rather, Philips has used one large 7.1-litre cooking space that can be divided into two 3.55-litre sections using a removable divider. Take the divider out, and you get one large cooking area.

On some days, we used the two sides independently. That meant putting one type of food in one section and something completely different in the other.

